ECOMPLETE COMMERCE WEBSITE BENCHMARK

Site: https://www.ecompletecommerce.com

Review date: 30 October 2026

Type: Static review of homepage and contact page, compared against published standards

OVERALL

Needs correction. 4 areas red, 3 amber, 2 unverified.

SCORECARD

- Brand and domain (RED): The Smollan rename went live on 1 September 2026. The site still runs as eComplete and its banner describes the move as a transition.
- Navigation (RED): 26 header and footer links point to /about, including Blog, Careers, Privacy and Data, and Solutions. Labelled destinations are unreachable.
- Trust and proof (RED): $350M+ revenue, 150+ stores, case-study growth percentages (65-75% organic, 75-88% revenue), +27% team capacity and +34% client lifetime value carry no timeframe, baseline or method.
- Privacy, POPIA (RED): The contact form collects name, email, country, company and monthly online revenue. The newsletter has a sign-up. Neither shows a visible privacy notice or consent wording in the extracted page.
- Accessibility, WCAG 2.2 AA (AMBER): Images have empty alt text in markup. The H1 appears twice and sections repeat 2 to 3 times. Contrast was not tested.
- SEO foundations (AMBER): Title, meta description, canonical and Open Graph tags are present. The blog link dead-ends, the H1 is duplicated, and structured data could not be confirmed.
- Conversion path (AMBER): One route to a 7-field form, which includes a revenue qualifier. No booking or phone option.
- Performance and security (UNVERIFIED): No Core Web Vitals field data, Lighthouse run, header or TLS check was performed.

STANDARDS USED

- Core Web Vitals: LCP at or below 2.5s, INP at or below 200ms, CLS at or below 0.1, each at the 75th percentile of real visits (web.dev threshold definitions).
- WCAG 2.2 AA for accessibility.
- POPIA for South African visitors and leads (notice at collection, s18; consent for electronic direct marketing, s69). Confirm with counsel.
- Standard SEO hygiene: crawlable navigation, unique H1, metadata, canonicals, structured data.

KEY FINDINGS

1. The brand is out of date. Smollan announced that eComplete Commerce became Smollan Digital Commerce on 1 September 2026. The homepage links to digitalcommerce.smollan.com but the rest of the site still presents as eComplete.
2. Navigation is broken as a system. The header and footer share one set of links, and nearly all of them resolve to /about. Users who click Blog, Careers or Privacy land on About.
3. Proof claims are unsourced. Growth percentages and revenue figures appear without period, baseline or methodology. A client quote (Reebok, 103%) needs client sign-off and underlying data.

4. Privacy posture is unclear. Lead capture happens without a visible notice or consent wording near the form or newsletter.
5. Accessibility and SEO basics have gaps. Empty alt text, duplicate headings and a dead blog reduce both assistive-technology use and search signal, despite SEO being a listed core service.
6. Copy consistency. The brand appears as "Ecomplete", "eComplete" and "Ecomplete Commerce"; spelling mixes British and American forms; the Worldwide page says 3 continents while the Smollan announcement cites five continents and 60+ markets.

CORRECTION PLAN

Weeks 0-2: stop the damage

- Fix header and footer routes so each link goes to its named page.
- Replace the "transition" banner with a dated notice pointing to the Smollan Digital Commerce site.
- Add a privacy notice and consent wording to the contact form and newsletter.
- Remove or source every unverified claim.
- Fix the duplicate H1 and add alt text to meaningful images.

Weeks 3-8: rebuild trust and conversion

- Publish case-study pages with method, time period, baseline and client sign-off.
- Launch working Blog and Careers pages.
- Split the form into a quick enquiry plus a booking link.
- Install analytics, Google Search Console and field Core Web Vitals monitoring.

Months 3-6: consolidate

- Map every URL on ecompletecommerce.com to the Smollan domain with 301 redirects.
- Submit a change-of-address in Search Console.
- Set a sunset date for the legacy site.
- A/B test the CTA and form length.

DECISIONS RECOMMENDED

1. Consolidate onto the Smollan domain with 301 redirects rather than running two live sites. Dual brands split link equity and confuse buyers.
2. Set a 90-day sunset for ecompletecommerce.com.
3. Pause new lead capture until the privacy notice is live.

LIMITS OF THIS REVIEW

- Only the homepage and contact page were fetched. No full crawl.
- No Lighthouse run, CrUX field data, response header or TLS check.
- FAQ answers, hidden duplicate sections and live form behaviour were not verified in a rendered browser.
- No accessibility tool run or contrast measurement.
- No peer benchmark yet. Recommended as the next step if the pitch needs competitive evidence.
- Standards references: web.dev Core Web Vitals threshold definitions; Smollan announcement of 1 September 2026 (smollan.com, LinkedIn and trade press coverage).

CLOSING THE GAPS (not covered by this review)
- Full site crawl: Screaming Frog export of all URLs. Status: open.
- Core Web Vitals: PageSpeed Insights on 5 key URLs plus CrUX field data. Status: blocked here, the review environment could not reach the site. Run from a machine with normal web access.
- Security headers and TLS: securityheaders.com and SSL Labs. Status: blocked here (same cause).
- Rendered accessibility: axe or Lighthouse on rendered pages, plus contrast checks. Status: open.
- FAQ and hidden sections: browser and DOM inspection. Status: open.
- Live form and consent: test submission and inspection of network calls, using a test account. Status: open.
- Peer benchmark: the same tests on 2-3 peer sites. Status: open.

TIMELINE WITH GATES
Weeks 0-2 (stop the damage) -> Gate 1: privacy notice live and links verified -> Weeks 3-8 (rebuild trust) -> Gate 2: CWV, accessibility and crawl baselines recorded -> Months 3-6 (consolidate) -> Final exit: 301s cover 100% of URLs and Search Console shows no new errors.
Rule: no phase starts until the previous gate passes.

COVERAGE STATUS (updated)
Closed in this pass:
- Smollan rename confirmed: eComplete Commerce became Smollan Digital Commerce on 1 September 2026.
- Shopify partner directory lists Ecomplete Commerce (Cape Town).
Partly closed:
- Domain: a third-party listing shows ecomplete.co.za; redirect status unknown.
Not measured or reviewed here:
- Site measurement: the review environment cannot resolve the domain, so no timing, header or TLS data.
- Internal pages (About, Solutions, Capabilities, Worldwide, Blog, Careers, Privacy): not reachable through the fetch tool.
- Peer benchmark: candidates identified, pages not reviewed.
Method and pass thresholds for every remaining check are in the coverage register (slides 9-10 of the deck):
- Full crawl: zero broken internal links; every key page indexable.
- Core Web Vitals: LCP <=2.5s, INP <=200ms, CLS <=0.1 at p75, mobile and desktop.
- Security headers and TLS: grade A or better; HSTS and CSP present; TLS 1.2+ only.
- Rendered accessibility: zero critical axe issues; WCAG 2.2 AA contrast.
- FAQ and hidden sections: answers visible; duplicates hidden from assistive technology.
- Live form and consent: notice and unticked consent before submit; no data sent before consent.
- Scripts, cookies, structured data: tags wait for consent; valid schema; sitemap lists all indexable pages.
- Peer benchmark: same checks on 2-3 comparable agencies; gap score per check.